Welding Safety Checklist (29 CFR 1910.252)

Use before hot work starts and while welding, cutting or brazing is under way.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.252

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item is marked Defect, do not start or continue the hot work until it is corrected, and record what was done.
3. The equipment manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.252: General requirements (Part 1910 Subpart Q: Welding, Cutting and Brazing) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-252-welding-cutting-brazing

SECTION A | Area preparation and authorization

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Area inspected and authorized Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(iv)	The authorizing person has inspected the area and named the precautions before work begins	☐	☐	☐	
2	Combustibles moved or covered Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(vii)	Combustibles at least 35 feet from the work, or, where moving them is impracticable, under flameproofed covers or behind metal guards or curtains	☐	☐	☐	
3	Floor cleared Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(v)	Floor clear of paper clippings, wood shavings, textile fibers and similar combustibles for 35 feet around the work	☐	☐	☐	
4	Floor and wall openings Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(i)	Cracks, floor openings, wall holes, open doorways and broken windows closed or protected so sparks cannot reach combustibles beyond them	☐	☐	☐	
5	Ducts and conveyors Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(viii)	Ducts and conveyors that could carry sparks to distant combustibles are protected or shut down	☐	☐	☐	
6	Sprinklers in service Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(vi)(B)	In a sprinklered building, sprinkler protection is not impaired	☐	☐	☐	
7	No explosive atmosphere Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(vi)(C)	No flammable gas, vapor, liquid or dust mixtures with air at the work, and no accumulation of combustible dust	☐	☐	☐	
8	Used containers cleaned Ref. 1910.252(a)(3)(i)	Used drums, barrels or tanks cleaned of flammables, greases, tars and acids before hot work	☐	☐	☐	
9	Extinguishing equipment Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(ii)	Extinguishers, hose, water pails or sand buckets suited to the combustibles present, ready for instant use	☐	☐	☐	
10	Far side of metal walls Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(x)	Combustibles behind a metal wall, partition, ceiling or roof relocated, or a fire watch posted on that side	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Fire watch and training

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Fire watch assigned where needed Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(iii)(A)	A fire watcher is assigned where more than a minor fire could develop or a condition in 1910.252(a)(2)(iii)(A) applies, such as combustibles within 35 feet	☐	☐	☐	
12	Fire watcher equipped and trained Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(iii)(B)	Fire watcher has an extinguisher or other firefighting equipment within reach and has been trained to use it	☐	☐	☐	
13	Alarm known Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(iii)(B)	Fire watcher knows where and how to raise the alarm	☐	☐	☐	
14	Watch after work ends Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(iii)(B)	Fire watch continues for at least a half hour after hot work ends	☐	☐	☐	
15	Welders and supervisors trained Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(xiii)(C)	Cutters, welders and their supervisors can show training in safe operation of the equipment and process	☐	☐	☐	
16	Fire protection located Ref. 1910.252(a)(2)(xiv)(F)	Firefighting equipment is properly located at the site	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Eye, face and body protection

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
17	Arc welding helmet Ref. 1910.252(b)(2)(i)(A)	Each arc welder or arc cutter uses a helmet or hand shield (submerged arc welding excluded)	☐	☐	☐	
18	Helper eye protection Ref. 1910.252(b)(2)(i)(A)	Helpers and attendants wear proper eye protection	☐	☐	☐	
19	Gas welding eye protection Ref. 1910.252(b)(2)(i)(B)	Gas welders and oxygen cutters wear goggles or other suitable eye protection	☐	☐	☐	
20	Lens marking Ref. 1910.252(b)(2)(ii)(G)	Lenses carry a permanent mark showing source and shade	☐	☐	☐	
21	Booth or screens Ref. 1910.252(b)(2)(iii)	Where the work permits, the welder works inside a booth or noncombustible screens with a low-reflectivity finish	☐	☐	☐	
22	Floor-level air Ref. 1910.252(b)(2)(iii)	Air can move freely under or through booths and screens at floor level	☐	☐	☐	
23	Adjacent workers shielded Ref. 1910.252(b)(2)(iii)	People next to the welding area are behind noncombustible or flameproof screens or shields, or wear appropriate goggles	☐	☐	☐	
24	Protective clothing Ref. 1910.252(b)(3)	Protective clothing and other PPE selected under 1910.132 for the size, nature and location of the job	☐	☐	☐	
25	Fall protection Ref. 1910.252(b)(1)(i)	Welders and helpers on platforms, scaffolds or runways are protected by railings, safety belts, life lines or an equally effective safeguard	☐	☐	☐	
26	Cable routing Ref. 1910.252(b)(1)(ii)	Welding cable and equipment kept out of passageways and off ladders and stairways	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Ventilation, fumes and hazard communication

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
27	Fume levels controlled Ref. 1910.252(c)(1)(iii)	Exhaust or general ventilation running and positioned so toxic fumes, gases and dusts stay below the 1910.1000 limits	☐	☐	☐	
28	Mechanical ventilation where required Ref. 1910.252(c)(2)(i)	Mechanical ventilation provided in spaces under 10,000 cubic feet per welder, under a 16-foot ceiling, or with obstructed cross ventilation	☐	☐	☐	
29	Exhaust hood position Ref. 1910.252(c)(3)(i)	Movable hood placed as near as practicable to the work	☐	☐	☐	
30	Degreasing vapors Ref. 1910.252(c)(11)(ii)	Chlorinated hydrocarbon degreasing located so its vapors cannot reach the welding atmosphere	☐	☐	☐	
31	Lead-bearing metals Ref. 1910.252(c)(7)(iii)	Lead-bearing metals and lead paint worked indoors only with local exhaust ventilation or airline respirators running	☐	☐	☐	
32	Labels and safety data sheets Ref. 1910.252(c)(1)(iv)	Workers can reach the labels and safety data sheets for the fluxes, filler metals and coatings in use	☐	☐	☐	
33	Filler metal notice Ref. 1910.252(c)(1)(v)(B)	Filler metal and fusible granular material containers carry the ventilation warning notice	☐	☐	☐	
34	First aid Ref. 1910.252(c)(13)	First-aid equipment on hand during all work	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Confined spaces and containers

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
35	Cylinders and machines outside Ref. 1910.252(b)(4)(iii)	Gas cylinders and welding machines are outside the confined space	☐	☐	☐	
36	Wheeled equipment blocked Ref. 1910.252(b)(4)(iii)	Heavy wheeled portable equipment securely blocked before work starts	☐	☐	☐	
37	Rescue means Ref. 1910.252(b)(4)(iv)	A way to pull the welder out quickly is in place, and any lifeline is attached so the body cannot jam in the opening	☐	☐	☐	
38	Outside attendant Ref. 1910.252(b)(4)(iv)	Attendant stationed outside, watching the welder continuously, with a preplanned rescue procedure	☐	☐	☐	
39	Ventilation and air supply Ref. 1910.252(c)(4)(i)	Space ventilated, and replacement air is clean and respirable	☐	☐	☐	
40	No oxygen ventilation Ref. 1910.252(c)(4)(v)	Oxygen is not being used to ventilate the space	☐	☐	☐	
41	Electrode holders Ref. 1910.252(b)(4)(v)	During long breaks in arc welding, electrodes are out of holders, holders placed safely and the machine disconnected	☐	☐	☐	
42	Torch and gas supply Ref. 1910.252(b)(4)(vi)	During long breaks, torch valves closed and fuel-gas and oxygen shut off at a point outside the space	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Confined spaces and containers

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
43	Hollow spaces vented Ref. 1910.252(a)(3)(ii)	Hollow spaces, cavities and containers vented to let air or gases escape before preheating, cutting or welding	☐	☐	☐	
44	Hot metal marked Ref. 1910.252(b)(4)(vii)	Hot metal marked or another warning given to other workers after welding	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME